

Remote Work Policy

[wiki/people/remote-work-policy](#) · Updated 2026-01-15 · Owner: People

Purpose

This policy sets expectations for remote and hybrid work at Northwind. It is maintained by the People team and applies to all employees whose roles can be performed remotely.

Northwind supports flexible work while recognising that some collaboration is best done together. The guidelines below aim to get the benefits of both.

Philosophy

We trust people to do their best work in the arrangement that suits them, within some shared structure that keeps teams connected. Flexibility is a benefit, not a loophole; it works because everyone holds up their side.

Working arrangements

- Employees may work remotely up to three days per week.
- Coordinate your in-office days with your team to maximise overlap.
- Teams may agree on fixed in-office days to make planning easier.

Core hours

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 15:00 local time. During core hours you should be reachable for meetings and quick questions. Outside core

hours you have more flexibility to structure your day, as long as your work and commitments are covered.

Time zones

For distributed teams, agree on an overlap window that respects everyone's core hours. Rotate the burden of inconvenient meeting times rather than always imposing it on the same people.

Expectations while remote

- Ensure a reliable internet connection for meetings.
- Keep your calendar accurate so colleagues know your availability.
- Be present and engaged in meetings, with your camera on where practical.
- Respond to messages within a reasonable time during working hours.

Communication

Default to clear, written communication so that people in different locations and time zones can follow along. Document decisions where others will need them, and prefer asynchronous updates over meetings when a meeting is not necessary.

Equipment and workspace

Equipment stipends are available once per year to help you set up a safe and productive workspace. Use company-approved devices for company work, and keep your workspace free from anyone who should not see

confidential information.

Security while remote

Follow the same security standards at home as in the office. Lock your screen when you step away, connect through the VPN when required, and never use public computers for company work. Treat your home network as you would any untrusted network.

Meetings and focus time

Protect focus time by keeping meetings purposeful and short. Default to no meeting when an asynchronous update will do. When you do meet, have an agenda and end with clear next steps.

Worked example

An engineer on a distributed team works remotely three days a week. They keep their calendar accurate, join the team's agreed overlap window during core hours, and use written updates for everything that does not need a meeting. They connect through the VPN for internal systems and lock their screen when they step away. On office days they coordinate with their team for maximum overlap.

Frequently asked questions

How many days can I work remotely? Up to three per week.

What are core hours? 10:00 to 15:00 local time, when you should be reachable.

Can I work from anywhere? Within your approved arrangement; fully remote or out-of-region work needs People team approval.

Common mistakes

- Treating flexibility as being unreachable during core hours.
- Letting your calendar drift out of date so nobody knows your availability.
- Relaxing security habits at home that you would keep in the office.
- Defaulting to meetings when a written update would be clearer and faster.

Wellbeing

Remote work can blur the line between work and personal time. Set boundaries, take breaks, and use your time off. Managers should model healthy habits and respect core hours.

Exceptions

Arrangements that differ from this policy, such as fully remote roles or different in-office expectations, require manager and People team approval.

Related documents

See the VPN Access guide for connecting remotely, the Updated Security Standards for device security, and the Expense Policy for equipment stipends.

Home office setup

A good remote setup protects both your productivity and your health. The annual equipment stipend is there to help you build one. Prioritise the things you use for hours every day.

- A reliable internet connection suitable for video meetings.
- A comfortable chair and a desk at the right height.
- An external monitor, keyboard, and mouse where helpful.
- Adequate lighting and a quiet space for calls.

Take regular breaks and set up your workspace to avoid strain; the company would rather you invest in a healthy setup than work through discomfort.

Hybrid collaboration

Hybrid teams work best when remote and in-office members have an equal experience. Small habits make a large difference to the people who are not in the room.

- In mixed meetings, have everyone join the video call individually so remote members are equal

participants.

- Share agendas and notes in writing so decisions are visible to everyone.

- Rotate meeting times fairly across time zones rather than always favouring one.
- Record decisions where distributed colleagues will need them later.